

I saw it again – something in his hand.

It wasn't what he held. It was how he held it.

He was speaking to one of the interns – young, new, trying to impress. She was talking too much. He didn't interrupt. He just lifted his hand halfway, open palm, two fingers slightly separated, as if to say: "I've already decided how this ends."

She stopped mid-sentence.

Didn't look offended.

Didn't even seem confused.

Just... froze.

He didn't raise his voice. Didn't change expression. Just that hand gesture. Subtle. Casual. Authoritative.

And in that moment, something shifted in my spine.

Because my father used to do the exact same thing.

When he wanted silence, he didn't shout. He didn't need to.

A single movement of his hand was enough to kill the room.

I hadn't seen that in years.

Until now.

R-3 didn't know I was watching.

But the intern left quickly.

And he stayed behind, sipping coffee like he'd tamed a wild animal.

This isn't about one woman.

This isn't about Beril.

It's a pattern.

And I've seen this pattern before.

Next step: Correlate with recorded gestures in archived memories.

There's a rhythm forming. I know it. I just don't want to say it yet.

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